

wouldn't recommend most people to opt for a 4G device anymore. Not unless they're living in extremely remote parts of the country. 5G will allow your



device to be future-proof. While the data speeds haven't risen as much as expected so far, it is still a significant enough boost.

6 Make your choice: Sleek v/s good battery

Since smartphones still use Lithium-ion batteries in 2023, there's a choice one needs to make when purchasing a



smartphone. Do you want your phone to be sleek and slender or do you want it to have excellent battery life? Most sub-8 mm phones we've tested in 2023 lack good battery life.

7 Larger camera sensor > More megapixels

Always choose to go for a phone with a larger camera sensor size over more megapixels. The number of megapixels



doesn't matter nearly as much as the size of the sensor. A bigger sensor will allow more light in, which will enhance the quality of low-light images. More megapixels just means more detail but it doesn't really matter as much because of the size of screens these pictures are viewed on and all the pixel-binning happening. More light intake is always more beneficial.

8 Pay closer heed to software updates

Unless you're one of those who change their smartphones as often as their undies, you would want to pay attention to software updates. With brands such



as Samsung, Xiaomi and others offering a good 4 years of OS updates, and Google bumping it all the way up to a whopping 7 years, 1 year of OS updates shouldn't be a thing anymore. Ensure to go with phones with at least 3 years of guaranteed software updates; that way, you can use a phone for a good 3 years without having to switch while being up to date with the latest software.

9 144 Hz - 165 Hz? Is it really needed?

Save your money and stay away from screens with 144 or 165 Hz refresh rate. Unless you're a pro-gamer, you won't really be able to tell much of a difference between good ol' 120 Hz



and 144 Hz. Instead, spend that dough upgrading to a 256 GB storage phone!

10 Now's a great time to invest in foldables

2023 is the year of the foldables. The software is much more mature, the



hinges are getting better than ever, durability has gone up, and some are even paying special attention to optics. Example: the new OnePlus Open. Head to our Tested section to read the full review.

11 Don't shy away from buying refurbished

Refurbished phones is the answer to getting a well-rounded phone at a palatable price. Often, these phones are



past their warranty period, but some refurbished phone sellers offer their own in-store warranty. You can also get more powerful hardware at a fraction of the price, which is always a win!

12 Environment friendly

OEMs are paying more attention than ever to green tech by using recycled materials, clean energy, less plastic in the packaging, and more. Let's do our part to save the environment by buying phones only when our own devices reach the end of their lifespan and help reduce e-waste. 